

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2  
♥ A 8 7 3  
♦ 9 7 4  
♣ J 10 2

♠ K Q J 5

♥ K 10

♦ A 8 3

♣ A 9 6 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 10 8 4

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K Q J 10 5

♣ K 8

♠ A 7 6

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ 6 2

♣ Q 7 5 3

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1NT   | Pass | 2♣    |
| Pass         | 2♠    | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ K    |       |      |       |

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♦ K, dummy plays the ♦ 2 and West the ♦ 4.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need 3 more winners, and they must come from the ♥ suit. The danger is that when you knock out the ♥ A, East may take too many ♦ s.

East continues with the ♦ Q; dummy plays the ♦ 6 and West the ♦ 7.

East continues with the ♦ J; dummy discards the ♣ 3 and West plays the ♦ 9.

You held up your ♦ A until the third round to exhaust West of ♦ s.

Next you start on ♥ s by playing ♥ K, then overtaking the ♥ 10. Assume that West wins the second ♥ .

You were fortunate it was West who took the ♥ A, and that he has no ♦ to return. If he plays a ♥ or a ♠ you will win in dummy. If he plays a ♣ you will jump up with the ♣ A and take your winners, 9 in all.

You were lucky the ♥ A was with West.

But if you had not held-up your ♦ A even good luck wouldn't have helped you.

**Board 2**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 10 5

♥ J 10

♦ 9 6 2

♣ J 7 6

♠ A 7 6

♥ A 8 6 5 3

♦ K 5

♣ A K 5



♠ 9 4 3

♥ Q 9 7 2

♦ A 8 4

♣ Q 10 2

♠ 8 2

♥ K 4

♦ Q J 10 7 3

♣ 9 8 4 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ K

1 ♥

Pass

1NT

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠ K.

East follows with the ♠ 3 and you play the ♠ 2.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 5

Even if ♥s split 3-3 you could only get 2 extra winners there, so it should be clear that you must establish the ♦s. You will have to drive out the ♦ A and hope they don't win too many ♠s at that time.

West continues with the ♠ Q.

East follows with the ♠ 4 and you play the ♠ 8. West continues with the ♠ J.

East follows with the ♠ 9 and you discard the ♣ 3. Holding up the ♠ A until the third round helps your chances.

Having just taken the third ♠ trick you now work on ♦s by first playing the ♦ K, then continuing the suit. East wins the third one with his ♦ A. And now the good news - he has no ♠ left to reach his partner's good tricks. So East plays the ♥ Q.

At this point in the play you have three tricks in the bank; ♠ A, ♦ K, ♦ Q. You take your ♥ K, cash the two good ♦s, then lead to dummy for the ♣ A K and ♥ A. Voila!

You were lucky that East had the ♦ A since he only had 3 ♠s.

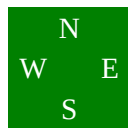
But what if East actually held 4 ♠s? No problem, in that case the ♠s would have split 4-4 so the defenders could only win 3 ♠ tricks and the ♦ A.

The hold-up lets you make the contract whenever East holds the ♦ A. And if West happened to hold the ♦ A??? You go down.

**Board 3**  
South Deals  
E-W Vul

♠ A 8 6  
♥ Q J 9 2  
♦ K 7 4  
♣ 9 7 3

♠ K 9 4  
♥ A 6 3  
♦ Q J 8 2  
♣ A Q 4



♠ Q J 7 3 2  
♥ 10 7  
♦ 6 5  
♣ J 10 8 2

♠ 10 5  
♥ K 8 5 4  
♦ A 10 9 3  
♣ K 6 5

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | Pass  |
| Pass         | 1NT   | Pass | 2♣    |
| Pass         | 2♦    | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠ 3    |       |      |       |

♦ K.

It's too bad the finesse didn't work, but it's not too too bad! Because West is out of ♠s and must lead one of the other suits. You don't care which he leads because you can now win 8 more tricks and make your contract.

As long as you were going to finesse into West you could establish the ♦s without allowing East to gain the lead.

And as long as you had held up on the ♠K until the third round you could ensure that West was out of ♠s if he had started with only 3.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ 3. West wins the first trick with the ♠ A and returns the ♠ 8.

East plays the ♠ Q and dummy the ♠ 10.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You can win 3 more ♦ tricks if the finesse works, but even if it doesn't work you can still get the 2 that you need. Of course if West does win the ♦ K it would sure be great if he had no ♠ to lead.

East continues with the ♠ J; dummy discards a ♥ and West plays the ♠ 6.

You ducked the second ♠ and took your ♠ K on the third round.

After winning the ♠ K you are conveniently in your hand, so you play the ♦ Q and let it ride when East plays a low card. Alas, West takes the trick with his

**Board 4**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ 10 8 4  
♥ 6 5 4 2  
♦ K Q J 4  
♣ 7 5

♠ Q 6  
♥ A 10 9  
♦ 7 5 2  
♣ K J 10 6 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 9 3 2  
♥ Q 8 3  
♦ 10 9 6  
♣ A Q 3

♠ A K 7 5  
♥ K J 7  
♦ A 8 3  
♣ 9 8 2

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass         | 3NT   |      | 1NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ K    |       |      |       |

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦ K, dummy plays the ♦ 2 and East the ♦ 6.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 6

You will need some ♣ tricks to make the contract. If West has 5 ♦s and also the ♣A then you will go down. It doesn't matter if he has the ♣Q because you can finesse him out of that.

But in the case where East has both the ♣ A Q you need to make sure he has no ♦ when he takes his first trick.

West continues with the ♦ Q; dummy plays the ♦ 5 and East the ♦ 9.

West continues with the ♦ J; dummy plays the ♦ 7 and East the ♦ 10.

You held up the ♦ A until the third round, everybody following.

Now start on the ♣s. Play your ♣9 and let it ride. East wins the ♣Q and returns a ♠. Good, he didn't have the fourth ♦.

Win with dummy's ♠Q and force out the ♣A.

The rest of the tricks are yours, nine in all.

If East had only held 2 ♦s it would have been OK to hold up your ♦ A just once.

But with this layout you needed to hold up twice.